

Military Leave Policy

1. Policy Statement

Westbrook University fully supports its student veterans and active-duty military members. This policy ensures that students called to military service can leave and return without academic or financial penalty, consistent with the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act and the Higher Education Opportunity Act.

2. Notification Requirements

Students who receive orders for active duty, training, or other military service should notify the Office of Student Affairs as soon as possible and provide a copy of their military orders. Notification should also be sent to the Financial Aid Office, Housing Office, and each instructor.

3. Academic Options

Students called to military service have the following options depending on timing:

- Before the 10th week: Full withdrawal with 'W' grades (no GPA impact) and full tuition refund
- After the 10th week with incomplete work: Instructor may assign an Incomplete (I) grade; student completes work upon return
- After the 10th week with substantially complete work: Instructor may assign a final grade based on work completed

4. Financial Aid During Military Leave

Students who withdraw due to military service are entitled to a full refund of tuition and fees for the semester. Student loan repayment may be deferred during active duty. Students should contact the Financial Aid Office and the loan servicer immediately upon receiving orders.

5. Return to Enrollment

Veterans and service members returning from military leave must submit a Return from Leave Application (see ACAD-WD-005) with a copy of discharge or release papers. Students are entitled to return to the same academic program and standing they held prior to their service leave, provided they return within 5 years of the start of their service period.